



CHRISTIAN ALLIANCE
INTERNATIONAL SCHOOL
宣道國際學校

16 June 2025

To Whom It May Concern,

I am writing to provide my highest recommendation for Brad Friis, an exceptional educational technologist with whom I have had the privilege of working closely over the past nine years. During this time, I have known Brad in my capacity as both a classroom teacher and senior leader in a multi campus New Zealand school, and more recently as the high school principal of an international school in Hong Kong.

My professional relationship with Brad began in 2016 when I embarked on an online Master's program focused on learning management systems (LMSs). After identifying Schoology as a leading LMS, I reached out to Brad, who generously offered full access to resources and support in exchange for research insights. His generosity, strategic thinking, and commitment to education were evident from the very beginning. I am now a doctoral candidate studying technology-enhanced feedback, a journey that has been inspired by my ongoing collaboration with Brad.

As the sole representative of Schoology in New Zealand, Brad has earned the nickname "Mister Schoology" among staff at the school I worked at. His unparalleled expertise in the product, combined with a thorough understanding of New Zealand's educational landscape, has made him an invaluable resource for schools. Over the years, Brad has led numerous hands-on and remote workshops for teachers and has always been willing to assist with both strategic planning and technical fixes. But more importantly, Brad also connected us with other educators and technical experts when needed, further enriching our professional networks and broadening the impact of Schoology within the education sector.

More specifically, under Brad's guidance, my previous school successfully adopted Schoology across multiple campuses, transforming it into a cornerstone of our teaching and learning ecosystem. His innovative approach included the development of a mastery system based on the "five Es" framework, which greatly enhanced our ability to assess and support students. Beyond the classroom, Schoology became the backbone of our co-curricular programs, supporting everything from sports teams and the Duke of Edinburgh Programme to music and student-led conferences. Brad also played a pivotal role in integrating parents into the platform, transforming them into active, informed partners in their children's education.

Thanks to Brad's long-term planning and foresight, our school was exceptionally well-prepared for the challenges of COVID-19. While many schools struggled, we transitioned seamlessly to online learning, maintaining consistent teaching and learning standards

through the use of linked sections. Brad's proactive approach laid the groundwork for this success, enabling us to move to asynchronous classes supported by weekly synchronous Zoom sessions overnight. Post-pandemic, the blended learning model has continued to thrive, yielding impressive results, including a 95% pass rate in the 2024 school year, despite many students requiring learning support.

Brad's support has been a constant through significant sector changes, including the disruptions of COVID-19, curriculum rewrites, and policy shifts. His steadfast belief in the value of Schoology, when implemented thoughtfully, has been a guiding force for our school. He consistently brought a student-centered mindset to our strategic conversations, contributing invaluable insight and humility to complex, system-level discussions. One of Brad's most remarkable qualities is his ability to support teachers, particularly those resistant to change. This because he recognises the challenges of technology adoption and works tirelessly to make transitions manageable and aligned with staff needs. His empathetic and proactive approach ensures that even the most hesitant team members became confident users of Schoology.

It is difficult to overstate the impact Brad has had on my previous school and the broader community of Schoology schools in New Zealand. His expertise, generosity, and commitment to fostering agency, equity and reducing teacher workload have been transformative. I wholeheartedly recommend Brad as an outstanding educational technologist and leader, capable of driving meaningful change and innovation in any educational setting.

Sincerely,
Andrew Bergh

High School Principal

